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to move on to another inclined plane of same angle of inclination as shown in the Figure 3.1(a). By increasing the smoothness of both the inclined planes, the ball reach almost the same height(h) from where it was released (L1) in the second plane (L2) (Figure 3.1(b)). The motion of the ball is then observed by varying the angle of inclination of the second plane keeping the same smoothness. If the angle of inclination is reduced, the ball travels longer distance in the second plane to reach the same height (Figure 3.1 (c)). When the angle of inclination is made zero, the ball moves forever in the horizontal direction (Figure 3.1(d)). If the Aristotelian idea were true, the ball would not have moved in the second plane even if its smoothness is made maximum since no force acted on it in the horizontal direction. From this simple experiment, Galileo proved that force is not required to maintain motion. An object can be in motion even without a force acting on it.

In essence, Aristotle coupled the motion with force while Galileo decoupled the motion and force.

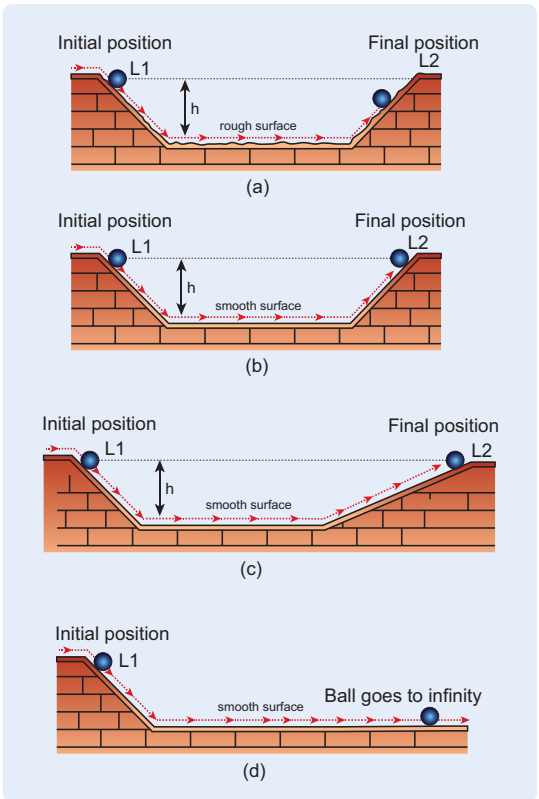


Figure 3.1 Galileo's experiment with the second plane (a) at same inclination angle as the first (b) with increased smoothness (c) with reduced angle of inclination (d) with zero angle of inclination

3.2 NEWTON'S LAWS

Newton analysed the views of Galileo, and other scientist like Kepler and Copernicus on motion and provided much deeper insights in the form of three laws.

3.2.1 Newton's First Law

Every object continues to be in the state of rest or of uniform motion (constant velocity) unless there is external force acting on it.

This inability of objects to move on its own or change its state of motion is called inertia. Inertia means resistance to change its state. Depending on the circumstances, there can be three types of inertia.

1. **Inertia of rest:** When a stationary bus starts to move, the passengers experience a sudden backward push. Due to inertia, the body (of a passenger) will try to